

# Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner sharpening the loan registration funnel.*

*Positioning*, nearly ten years owning complex user journeys, cross-functional delivery, and data-driven iteration – brought to smava's onboarding route.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · [www.true-north.berlin](http://www.true-north.berlin) · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

---

Dear smava team,

The registration route is not a feature – it is the handshake between every euro of marketing spend and every loan offer that reaches a customer. I have spent the better part of a decade owning exactly that kind of high-stakes, data-instrumented user journey, and the smava Product Owner role maps cleanly onto how I work.

At Rohde & Schwarz, I owned end-to-end delivery on a data platform where the "onboarding" was a multimodal data ingestion pipeline feeding downstream ML training. The analogy to a credit-comparison funnel is direct: a user enters with a need, the system qualifies them through a sequence of steps, and every friction point either converts or loses them permanently. I ran that product from user stories through implementation support, QA, and GitOps rollout – the same ownership arc the smava posting describes. At Emil Group, I re-established sprint discipline for a 17-person team that had lost delivery rhythm under pressure, split it into smaller Scrum units with clear ownership, and rebuilt client trust through structured weekly product workshops. That is the kind of cross-functional coordination and delivery accountability I bring to a role.

What excites me specifically about the smava setup is the explicit pairing of A/B testing ownership with direct QA responsibility. Too often experimentation and quality live in separate teams and the handoff between them is where learning gets lost. Owning both means I can design an experiment, instrument it correctly, verify the implementation myself, and close the learning loop with Marketing and peer product teams on factual data rather than approximations. I have operated at that level of end-to-end ownership throughout my career, including serving as Deputy IT Security Officer at the Federal Employment Agency, where I was responsible for data lineage and compliance governance alongside product delivery.

I do not have a prior role inside a consumer lending product specifically. What I have is a demonstrated ability to pick up regulated, high-consequence user journeys quickly and to instrument them for improvement. The onboarding and registration flows I have owned – in

healthcare, insurance, and identity – share the same structural challenge as smava's: users arrive with a goal, the system has a compliance requirement, and the product team's job is to reduce the distance between those two realities without losing either.

I would welcome the opportunity to walk through a specific experiment brief or funnel audit as part of the interview process – that is a faster signal of fit than any amount of general conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

---